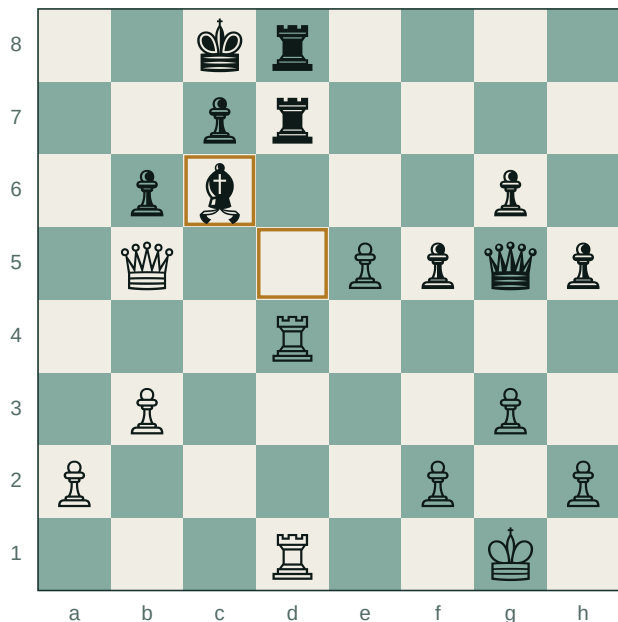


Interference tactics: White, move 27

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 26...Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Qxc6 Rxd4 28. Qa8+ Kd7 29. Rxd4+

27.Qxc6 The queen captures the bishop on c6. Recorded reply: **27...Rxd4**.

28.Qa8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **28...Kd7**.

29.Rxd4+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c6 and queen on g5. Check for tactical protection.